

Chapter 1

In the opening chapter of book 20 Amm. returns to Julian, whom he had taken leave of in 18.3.1 with the eulogistic phrase *haec dum in Galliis caelestis corrigii cura*, followed by *in comitatu Augusti turbo novarum exortitur rerum*, introducing the downfall of Barbatio. In a similar sequence Julian is depicted in ch. 1 as the responsible and competent leader, whereas in ch. 2 Constantius compromises the Roman position in the East by dismissing Ursicinus.

Amm. describes the military situation on the borders of Britain and Gaul as unstable and menacing, which justifies both Lupicinus' mission and Julian's decision to stay in Paris himself. It also helps to explain why later on Constantius' order to transfer troops to the East (20.4.2–3) is resented by the soldiers and looked upon with anxiety by Julian (20.4.4–5).

As Szidat has pointed out (I 42 and 97), Lupicinus' mission to Britain might have been told in connection with Julian's pronunciamiento in Paris. That, however, would have made the reader suspicious with regard to Julian's real motives in sending Lupicinus away. Szidat's suggestion that Amm. separates the two events precisely to avoid this suspicion is convincing.

I.1 *Haec ... rerum series fuit* The opening sentence refers to the content of bks. 18 and 19. *Rerum series* is found only here in Amm., who prefers *series gestorum* (25.8.12, 25.8.15, 27.9.3, 28.1.22, 29.1.4., – *rerum gestarum* in 27.11.7). *Rerum series* is found once in Livy: 21.5.3 *rerum serie ... tractus ad id bellum*. For the similar expressions *ordo rerum* and – *gestorum*, used by Amm. to conclude digressions (14.8.15, 22.16.24, 23.4.15) and in recapitulating sentences (17.13.16, 20.11.1), see Samberger, 1969, 378/9. In 29.3.1 Amm. combines the two expressions: *conjunctur ordo seriesque gestorum*. Comparable opening sentences are listed by De Jonge ad 18.1.1.

per Illyricum perque orientem In the fourth century, until the final division of the Empire in 395, the region along the eastern side of the Adriatic, from Epirus to Noricum, normally formed part of one *praefectura Illyrici Italiae et Africae*. During some periods, however, Illyricum was an independent prefecture. Cf. ad 19.11.2 and see Palanque, 1969, who, modifying and rectifying his own earlier opinions (cf. Palanque, 1951 and 1955) finally reached the following conclusion: "Je pense donc que la grande préfecture d'Illyricum a existé de 345 à 361 et de 375 à 379 seulement. Elle ne reparaitra que fugitivement en 387 ..." (Palanque, 1969, 605). See now also Demougeot,

1981. By *Oriens* can be meant either the *dioecesis Orientis* (more precisely: parts of that diocese, cf. the note ad 18.5.2) or, in a wider sense, the East including the dioceses of *Asiana* and *Ponica* (cf. the note ad 18.6.19). In view of the events described in bk. 19 the former is to be preferred here.

consulatu vero Constantii ... incitatis et bella Amm. combines the three essential elements, time (*consulatu Constantii*), place (*in Britannii*), and central figure (*Caesar*) in one opening sentence (cf. Chausserie-Laprée, 1969, 41/2). Its structure is complicated by the insertion of participle constructions and the accumulation of subordinate clauses. The sentence may be analysed as follows:

consulatu ... Iuliani
in Britannii cum Scottorum ... excursus ... vastarent
rupta quiete condicta
et implicaret formido provincias
cladium congerie fessas
hiemem agens apud Parisios
distractusque in sollicitudines varias
(ut retulimus ... fecisse Constantem)
ne ... relinquere Gallias
Alamannis ... incitatis

consulatu ... Constantii deciens terque Iuliani The year 360. For the use of the multiplicative *deciens* and *ter* with *consulatu* cf. 14.10.1 *Constantius consulatu suo septies et Caesaris iterum*. In the abl. abs. *Augusto novies seque iterum consule* (16.11.1) the multiplicative are less surprising. A similar expression is found already in Nepos *Han.* 5.3 *M. Claudium Marcellum quinquies consulens*, TLL IV 570.10; Szantyr 214.

Scottorum Pictorumque The *Scotti* (or *Scotti*), a Celtic tribe of Ireland, settled in Scotland in the course of the fourth century. Together with the *Picti*, who lived in the northern part of Britain, they threatened the Roman provinces according to Amm. not only in 359, but also in 365 (26.4.5) and in 367 (27.8.5 *eo tempore Picti in duas gentes divisi, Diddidonas et Veturiones*). Cf. Szidat and Todd, 1981, 231–2.

gentium ferarum excursus ... vastarent For the phraseology cf. 14.10.1 *quorum crebris excursibus vastabantur confines limitibus terrae. Gentes ferae* is used regularly by Amm. to indicate tribes and peoples on the borders of the Empire: 15.10.2 and 25.4.12 (Germans), 19.2.12 and 18.4.1 (the Persians and

their allies), 29.5.44 (Africans), 31.12.8 (Huns). The expression *excursus vastarent* (cf. *formido implicaret* below) is treated in Blomgren 83–94 under the heading of personification. It should be noted, however, that abstract subjects with *vastare* are common in all periods of Latin.

rupta quiete condicta Amm. refers to the expedition of Constans in 343, mentioned immediately below and in 27.8.4. For *quies* 'peace, tranquil conditions' cf. Liv. 2.48.6 *bellum quiete, quietem bello in vicem eludentes*. *Quies* is a goddess in 19.11.6, q.v. *Condicere* 'to agree upon' also occurs in 26.6.14. With this meaning it is found for the first time in Plautus (*Cur.* 5). It reappears with some frequency from Apuleius onwards, TLL IV 139.8 sqq.

loca limitibus vicina The expression can, of course, refer both to the neighbourhood *trans* and to that *cis* Hadrian's wall, but, as Szidat rightly observes, in 359 the Roman sphere of influence north of the wall will have been the main target of the enemy raids. For an analysis of the defense systems in the different periods of the Roman Empire in general and of the function of *limites* in particular see Luttwak, 1976.

implicaret formido Amm. uses *implicare* in this way again in 20.4.13 *hocque angore impliciti* and 26.6.20 *adventantium periculorum angoribus implicatus*. It is found often, but not exclusively, in poetry: Verg. *A.* 11.108–9 *quaenam vos tanto fortuna ... implicuit bello, Culex 200 implicuit (v.l. implevit) dira formidine mentem*, TLL VII 1.643.28.

provincias Britannia prima, Britannia secunda, Maxima Caesariensis and *Flavia Caesariensis*. Cf. the note ad 14.5.7, Frère, 1967, 210–212 and see, for later developments, Hind, 1975. In one of the lost books Amm. had given a description of Britain (cf. 27.8.4).

congerie *Congeries* is used by Amm. both in its literal meaning (15.10.4 and 17.12.4 *pruniarum*–, 23.2.8 'hay stacks') and metaphorically, cf. 21.16.11 and 31.15.5 *malorum*–. As TLL IV 276.54 sqq. shows, it becomes more frequent in later Latin prose, e.g. Hier. *Ep.* 77.7; August. *Serm.* 261.10; Maer. *Sat. praef.* 1.4 and 1.5.1.

hiemem agens apud Parisios Caesar There is no specific reference to the last mention of Julian's whereabouts in 18.2. Samberger, 1969, 439 rightly interprets this as a sign that the narrative about Julian is not simply continued but that we enter a new phase in his history.

Apud Parisios 'in Paris', *Lutetia* (or *Luticia*, cf. the note ad 15.11.3) is used

by Amm. only once (15.11.3), as against *Parisii* twelve times. Cf. Szidat and see the chapter "Et Lutèce devint Paris ... (fin IIIe – fin Ve siècles)" in Périn, 1984, 362–372.

distractusque in sollicitudines varias Cf. 22.10.1 *quibus distrahebatur multiformibus curis*, 31.7.1 *haec ... Valentem principem in sollicitudines varias distraxerunt*, Liv. 22.7.10 *tot in curas distracti animi ... erant*, Hier. *adv. Iovin.* 1.13 *in multis ... sollicitudinum partes miseriarumque distractus*, TLL V 1.1542.17–44.

verebatur ire subsidio transmarinis Vereor with inf. is found only here in Amm. With this meaning ('to be afraid (to do something)') it is found from Plautus onwards, Szantyr 347. In classical prose *transmarinus* is used as an attribute with *gentes* (Liv. 26.24.4), *vectigalia* (Cic. *Agr.* 2.80), *regiones* (Sen. *Ep.* 17.3); this seems to be the first place where it is used substantively.

ut retulimus ante fecisse Constantem Constans was the youngest son of Constantine the Great and Fausta, made *Caesar* in 333 and, together with his brothers Constantine II and Constantius II, declared *Augustus* in 337. In 340 a war broke out between Constans and Constantine II, in which the former was victorious. He ruled as sole emperor in the West until his death in 350. Cf. Seeck, 1901; Moreau, 1959 and *PLRE I*, Constans 3. In 27.8.4 Amm. refers to his description, now lost, of the military campaigns of Constans in Britain, which took place in 343.

rectore *Rector* is a very general word, used by Amm. for all kinds of high officers and officials. "Rapporté à l'empereur, il sert à qualifier et à exprimer un jugement plutôt qu'une définition. Il figure le responsable, du bon au pire; il entre dans la phraseologie du Chef. Chez Ammien, *rector* a un sens concret, plus affectif que cérébral", Béranger, 1976, 56. Cf. the note ad 14.10.8 and A. and A. Cameron, 1964, 326.

Alamanis ad saevitiam etiamtum incitatis et bella Etiamtum refers to the great victories won by Julian. At the same time it foreshadows the war to be fought against the Alamanni by Valentinian in 369. According to Müller-Seidel, 1955, 235, fear of the Alamanni in 360 was not justified by the facts, but only used by Julian as a pretext for staying in Gaul himself while removing Lupicinus. Cf. Szidat and, in general, Barceló, 1981, 34–49. This view has been contested by Blockley, 1980 (1), 480, who argues that it would have been too dangerous for Julian to leave Lupicinus isolated in Britain with a notoriously fractious part of the western army. Drinkwater, 1983, 378–379, on the other hand, accepted the suggestion, but only with a proviso.

According to him Lupicinus' removal had been arranged not by Julian himself, but by a small group of the Caesar's friends (throughout his paper Drinkwater argues against any direct involvement of Julian in the events leading up to the pronouncement). See for Amm. on the Alamanni Neuscheler, 1938 and on the history of the Alamanni in general Dirheimer-Gottlieb, 1976–1984, Christlein, 1979.

ad saevitiam ... et bella More examples of this type of inconcinnitas, viz. the combination of substantives in the singular and the plural, in Hagendahl, 1921, 113 sqq.

1.2 *ad haec ratione vel vi componenda* *Vel vi* is a certain emendation by Valesius of *vel VE*, based on the identical expression in the preceding chapter (19.13.2). Müller-Seidel, 1955, 233, interprets this repetition as an indication of a change in Julian's policy towards the barbarians. Julian's more diplomatic approach is to be understood, in her opinion, as part of his preparations to seize power. The phrase may be intended as an apology: Julian gave Lupicinus the same instructions as Constantius had given Lauricius in similar circumstances, thereby showing his adherence to the policy of his superior (19.13.2).

ire ... Lupicinum placuit As the cursus shows, Amm. accentuates this proper name on the antepenultimate despite the fact that the penultimate is long (Szantyr I 224). Cf. 18.2.7 *Florentio et Lupicino*, 20.4.9 *absentis Lupicini*, 20.9.5 *successorem Lupicini*. The same applies to the name Ursicinus.

After the death of his predecessor Severus (who seems to have died shortly after the summer of 358, cf. 17.10.1), Fl. Lupicinus was, in 358 or 359, invested with the office of *magister equitum per Gallias*, or rather (Demandt, 1970, 577 rightly warns against the habit of using later attested titles anachronistically), with the office which in due course of time officially (cf. *Not. Dign. Occ.* 1.7) came to be called the *magisterium equitum per Gallias* (compare for this office the note ad 20.2.1). The official title is not found in Amm., who is somewhat loose and inexact in his use of military titles, for the sake of variety (cf. Rolfe, I, 1935, xxxiv n. 3; De Jonge ad 15.5.36), or to avoid technical terms (cf. Szidat I, 101; A. & A. Cameron, 1964, 326), but also perhaps because at this date terminology was still flexible. It should be borne in mind that this post was created only recently (in 355, according to Demandt, 1970, 573–574, contra Ensslin, 1930, 111). Lupicinus did not occupy his post in Gaul for long: in 360 he was succeeded by Gomoarius (see the note ad 20.9.5 for a possible explanation for this change), but continued his military career in the following years. Cf. for details Seeck, 1927 and *PLRE I*, Lupicinus 6. See also Von Haehling, 1978, 254–255.

In 18.2.7 Lupicinus was mentioned simply as *Severi successor*. Now that he